

Colorado Green Chile

Chicharrón-enriched · fire-roasted · breakfast-burrito-ready

YIELD	TIME	PEPPERS	CHICHARRÓN
~6 cups · 8–10	45 min / 1.5 hr	2:1 Anaheim:chilaca	115–170 g

KEY TARGETS

char it hard, leave some fleck — brown the onion for fond

Pepper char	85–90% blackened	Onion	Deep golden, fond forming
Char retention	10–15% flecks left after peel	Sauce	Coats a spoon, mounds on the plate
Chicharrón	Bends, doesn't snap or dissolve	Final	Sits on a burrito without running

INGREDIENTS

peppers at room temp — cold peppers char unevenly

PEPPERS — 1.3–1.5 KG

Anaheim ~8–10	900 g
Chilaca ~4–5	450 g
Serrano to taste	5–7

AROMATICS

White onion fine dice	1 large
Garlic minced	6–8 cloves
Mexican oregano	1 g
Cumin	0.5 g

BASE

Beef tallow or lard	30 g
Chicken stock	900–1000 ml
AP flour to consistency	16–32 g
Kosher salt by weight	14 g

PORK + FINISH

Chicharrón plain, thick-cut	115–170 g
White vinegar or lime finish	5–10 ml

Mise before the flame: peppers at room temp (cold chars unevenly), stock measured and ready, onion diced + garlic minced, chicharrón broken into rough **1" pieces**, a heavy pot (Dutch oven) hot, and a bowl + cover to steam the peppers. This one cooks fast once the onion hits the fat — have it all set.

Roast & Build

METHOD

char aromatics too (onion halved + garlic, 30–40% char) for a deeper upgrade

- 1 **Char:** fire-roast all peppers over flame or under the broiler, rotating to **85–90% blackened**. Steam covered in a bowl **15 min**, then peel — leave **10–15% charred flecks** — and stem/seed. **Rough-chop half** (body), leave half in big pieces (texture).
- 2 **Build base:** heat the tallow over medium-high, add the onion and cook to **deep golden with fond, 8–10 min**. Add garlic + oregano + cumin, **30 sec** until fragrant.
- 3 **Add peppers:** stir them in to coat, pour in the stock, bring to a simmer.
- 4 **Thicken:** sprinkle flour **~8 g at a time**, stirring constantly, until it coats a spoon and holds when drizzled (usually **16–32 g**).
- 5 **Chicharrón:** add the rough 1" pieces, simmer **30–45 min**. Most melts in for richness; the bigger pieces stay. Done when they **bend, not snap**.
- 6 **Finish:** salt **aggressively** — it needs more than you think. Optional **5–10 ml vinegar or lime** at the end for brightness. Final texture: thick enough to **sit on a burrito without running**.

TROUBLESHOOTING

PROBLEM	CAUSE	FIX
Thin / runny	Under-thickened	Flour slurry: 8 g flour + 30 ml water
Bitter	Over-charred peppers	Pinch of sugar; can't fully fix
Bland	Under-salted	Season aggressively; acid helps too
No pork depth	Chicharrón too thin	Thicker cut; add extra lard
Chicharrón mushy	Simmered too long	Add half early, half in the last 10 min
Too thick	Over-floured	Thin with stock, re-adjust salt

The chicharrón is seasoning, not bulk — most dissolves into the sauce for richness; the few intact pieces you find are a bonus, so don't over-add. **Poblano sub:** no chilaca? Use poblano, char harder, and add 1–2 extra serranos. **Pork-forward upgrade:** roast 1 kg pork neck (220°C / 425°F, 45 min), simmer in 2 L water 3–4 hr, and use that as the stock. **Storage:** best same or next day; the chicharrón version keeps ~48 hr — for longer, freeze the base *without* chicharrón (3 months) and stir it in fresh on reheat.